

EXPLOITED VULNERABILITY ADVISORY: CVE-2026-81578

Summary

CVE-2026-81578 in PaperCut NG/MF is being actively exploited in the wild. An improper access control vulnerability exists in the web management interface of PaperCut MF and PaperCut NG. Under specific conditions, unauthenticated remote requests targeting administrative functions can trigger backend actions prior to the completion of access validation checks. This allows an unauthenticated remote attacker to modify certain system configurations. CISA requires federal remediation by 2026-09-14; under the CRA, exploitation of an affected product must be reported within 24 hours.

What we know

- **CVE:** CVE-2026-81578
- **Affected:** PaperCut NG/MF
- **Exploitation:** Actively exploited, added to CISA KEV on 2026-08-31
- **Severity:** CVSS 9.8 Critical, Network-exploitable, no privileges required, no user interaction (CVSS:3.1/AV:N/AC:L/PR:N/UI:N/S:U/C:H/I:H/A:H)
- **Exploitation likelihood (EPSS):** 1%
- **Weakness:** CWE-306

Recommended action

Patch CVE-2026-81578 by 2026-09-14. If you cannot patch immediately, restrict network access to the affected service now (segment it, put it behind a VPN, or take it offline) until you can patch. If you ship an affected product, be ready to file the CRA 24-hour report the moment you find it exploited.

Sources: CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities, NIST NVD. Public data; an advisory of active exploitation, not an incident report. Verify applicability to your estate before acting.